

Automated Infrastructure & Proactive Exception Tracking for Transiberia

Freight coordinator, Spain & Portugal · 120 employees · 1,000 loads/week · operating since 1987 (39 years)

1. The Problem

Transiberia coordinates 1,000 loads per week across Spain and Portugal with no owned fleet — its value is long-term carrier relationships and operational coordination. Every core process — order entry, carrier assignment, delivery tracking, exception handling — runs manually across email, WhatsApp, Excel, and a 2005 SAP system acting as a CRM, not a TMS. There is no single source of truth; problems surface only after a customer complains.

3–5% EXCEPTION RATE/WK <i>Loads needing manual intervention</i>	20–30 hrs LOST WEEKLY <i>Reactive troubleshooting</i>	€80 COST PER LOAD <i>Target: €40 post-automation</i>	€4.16M ANNUAL PROCESS COST <i>Before delays or penalties</i>
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At a 5–6% margin, this leaves no room for error — the 12-month growth target (+25–40% volume, €16–21M revenue) is unreachable without first fixing the cost base. Scaling volume on today's operations scales the losses, not the profit.

2. Recommendation

Build a connected layer on top of the existing infrastructure — compose, not replace. SAP stays the system of record; three components are added and integrated:

Cloud TMS	A modern Transportation Management System (Alpega/Transporeon-class) — one view of every load: carrier, status, location, ETA.
SAP BTP Integration Suite	Middleware connecting the Cloud TMS to SAP, email, PDFs and Google Drive. Information entered once flows everywhere — no re-keying.
WhatsApp Business API	Carriers already use WhatsApp. Messages are read automatically via Twilio and fed into the TMS; alerts and POD requests go back the same way.

Core investment: €444,350 — within the €500K budget, €55,650 headroom. **Implementation: ~11 months** across 6 phases. **Payback: 3–4 months.** **Year 1 net return: €1.38M–€1.56M.**
Optional Generative AI layer (€116,000) can be added after Core go-live, without rebuilding anything.

3. Why This Fits Transiberia Specifically

- **It preserves the carrier relationships.** Transiberia's edge is long-term trust with carriers, not technology — this changes how information flows, not who the parties are.
- **It meets carriers where they are.** WhatsApp integration is the specific answer to the fact that most Spanish and Portuguese carriers won't adopt a new platform.
- **No SAP re-platform required.** A full S/4HANA migration typically runs \$1M–\$8M+, and over 60% of such projects exceed budget. This delivers the same operational outcome in ~11 months by composing around SAP, not replacing it — subject to confirming Gateway support in Phase 1 (see Next Step).
- **The sequencing matches the margin reality.** Fix → Scale → AI. Cost control comes first at a 5–6% margin; the Generative AI layer is an optional phase, added only once the Core is stable.

4. Next Step

Sign off Phase 1 — Ecosystem & Process Assessment: €64,350, fixed fee, 8 weeks. No build commitment until Phase 1 is complete.

Delivers: full audit of SAP, WhatsApp and Excel workflows; confirmation of whether the SAP release supports NetWeaver Gateway (determines whether an additional €100K–250K SAP upgrade is needed before build); Cloud TMS vendor shortlist and fit-gap analysis; and a validated cost estimate for the Core.

Assessment workshops with Marc and the operational leads are ready to begin next week.

Annex A — Business Case & Sources

Full calculations behind this brief, and every source used

Business Case & Detailed Calculations. Every number in this brief — assumptions, formulas and cell-level sources, including the SilverTrust Cost Detail day-rate breakdown and the Systems Cost & Net ROI comparison — is documented in the full Transiberia Business Case workbook.

[Open the Business Case model →](#)

LABOR & COST BENCHMARKS (SPAIN)

Barcelona logistics coordinator salary *Glassdoor*

Spain employer social security contribution rate *Centre Gestor*

Spain standard working hours *Rivermate*

Spain statutory leave entitlement *Boundless HQ*

FREIGHT & LOGISTICS BENCHMARKS

Freight-forwarder margin benchmarks (5–6%) *GoFreight*

European road freight rate benchmark, €/load *Trans-road*

SAP & TECHNOLOGY

SAP Cloud Connector & NetWeaver Gateway prerequisites *SAP Community — Cloud Connector Guide*

SAP ECC 6.0 end-of-mainstream-maintenance timeline *TalentMSH — ECC 6.0 End of Life*

SAP S/4HANA migration cost benchmark (\$1M–\$8M+, 60%+ over budget) *Tachyon Tech*

Cloud TMS (Alpega-class) pricing reference *ERP Research*

Not independently sourced: recurring subscription costs, Generative AI usage costs and the SAP technical-upgrade contingency are SilverTrust illustrative planning figures, pending vendor quotes and the Phase 1 assessment — see the Business Case model above for cell-level detail.